

Colorado Field Ornithologists Sight Record Form

CFO-RC FILE X:

Rcd 2/18/01 wpl (2 photos)

RESULTS:

Species:(Common Name) Eurasian Wigeon

(Scientific Name) *Anas penelope*

Date(s) of occurrence: 10 January, 26 February and 21 April 2000

Number of birds seen: 1

Sex: male

Age: 1st winter → spring

Exact location: Pueblo City Park

County: Pueblo County

Nearest town: Pueblo

Elevation:

Length of observation: Total of 2 hours

Time(s) of observation: morning (7:15-10:00)

Other observers who saw the bird(s) with you: Brandon Percival, Marshall Iliff (MD)

Other Observers who independently saw the bird(s): The bird was first found by Van Truan, subsequently by Paul Hurtado. Mark Janos, Tony Leukering, Joey Kellner and many other observers also saw the bird at various times. To my knowledge, there was a period of a month or more when the bird was not seen prior to 21 April when Brandon and I refound the bird and video was taken.

Light Conditions (quality; direction relative to bird(s); position: good light.

Optical equipment used: B & L Elite 10 x 42 binocular, and B & L Elite 20 – 60x scope

Distance from bird(s) (estimated unless otherwise noted): 150 – 20 meters

Was bird(s) photographed? Video on 21 April

If so, have you submitted photos? Yes videographs included

Who took the photographs? Christopher L. Wood

Describe the general and specific habitat in which the bird(s) occurred: Arkansas River and City Park

Description: Images are captured stills taken from video taken on 21 April. Note the gray flanks and completely rufous head – unlike any hybrid American Wigeon x Eurasian Wigeon.



Describe bird's call or song: This was the first time I have heard this species in the US. On 21 April, the bird gave several drawn out calls. Each call was similar to male American Wigeon, by single parted, higher pitched and more drawn out.

Discuss similar species and how you eliminated them: The only confusion species is a hybrid Eurasian Wigeon x American Wigeon. There is no sign of any green in the head or buff feathers in the face, aside from the buff forehead typical of male Eurasian Wigeon. The uniform gray flanks and call are also typical of Eurasian Wigeon. There is no reason to suspect a hybrid.

What is your prior experience with this and similarly appearing species? I have seen hundreds of Eurasian Wigeon in Europe and a few in the US. I have seen thousands of American Wigeon.

List books, guides, recordings or other sources consulted and how this influenced your identification (during and after observation): None.

This report is from notes made during XX or after observation or later from memory

Date of written report: 2 February 2001

Reporting observer: Christopher L. Wood, zeledonia@att.net

Signature: *Christopher L. Wood (electronic submission)*

Reporting Observer's Address: 3465 S Otis Court

City: Lakewood

State: Colorado

Zip: 80227